

Reid Hoffman

Ex-CEO of LinkedIn and now executive Vice President of PayPal
is among the initial investors in Facebook

The missing link

We spoke to Hari Krishnan, newly appointed as Country Manager – LinkedIn India after he set up the first Indian office

Q Tell us more about your association with LinkedIn, LinkedIn's presence in India, and the experience so far.

A LinkedIn opened its first APAC office in India in December 2009, a month after I came on board as Country Manager for India. We have over 4 million LinkedIn members from India so LinkedIn is really not *new* to India. Now that we're here, we'll focus on developing localised user engagement activities to grow the member base and our effort will be to connect all of the country's professionals to help make them more successful and productive.

Q Would you be having a technical team here, or will this be a corporate / marketing presence?

A The India team is currently being led by me. Nayan Patel, from our Mountain View office, has taken the role of Director of Operations at LinkedIn India to support early market development activities, start local operations in Mumbai and develop strategic partnerships. We'll assess staffing needs in India over the next couple of quarters. We don't have a big team globally and expect to have about 500 people worldwide by the end of the year.

Q Why did you decide on India?

A Career management and professional networking go hand in hand. The need is immense in India — a country poised to be a \$80 billion software market in 2010 in the IT sector, providing direct employment to more than 2.2 million besides nearly twice the number by way of indirect employment. In India, the potential we see is being able to connect all Indian professionals to be more successful and productive. Professional networking is growing in India. LinkedIn provides a unique opportunity for existing and potential LinkedIn members to engage online and use



LinkedIn as an effective career management tool. We see an immense potential in being able to connect all Indian professionals to be more successful and productive. Like I said earlier, our Indian member base is growing and we need to work towards ensuring there is active engagement taking place.

Q What plans do you have for the future in India?

A We are focused on growing member awareness and member engagement. Our immediate task is to educate the Indian professionals on the potential of LinkedIn as a career management tool. We'll focus on developing localised user engagement activities to grow the member base and marketing partnerships to drive member engagement. We want to position ourselves as a platform for Indian professionals to be more successful and productive. The business partnership with Network 18 is the first big activity that we're focusing on now. We plan to engage in some more consumer outreach activities through the year.

Q What does LinkedIn have to offer independent application developers?

A LinkedIn is now available to any developer at developer.linkedin.com. Now, any developer can simply request a key and get access to LinkedIn's rich set of APIs to make business applications better. By opening our APIs to third party developers, we are allowing an enormous community to create potentially unlimited innovations around our platform, impacting the business success of millions of professionals around the world.

Q After Twitter do you plan to add compatibility with more platforms?

A LinkedIn is continuously looking for ways to propel the professional conversation forward. Our partnership with Twitter is an ongoing one. This is just the first of several integrations members will see over the coming months. User engagement will drive LinkedIn's growth and we are focused on developing more opportunities for our members to make the most from the LinkedIn platform. **d**